

Lecture 10: Universal and Perfect Hashing

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October 1, 2026

601.433/633 Introduction to Algorithms

Introduction

Another approach to dictionaries (insert, lookup, delete): hashing

- ▶ Can improve operations to $O(1)$, but with many caveats!

Should have seen some discussion of hashing in data structures. Also in CLRS.

- ▶ Separate chaining vs. open addressing

Today: discussion of caveats, more advanced versions of hashing (universal and perfect)

Hashing Basics

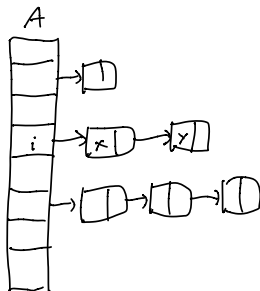
- ▶ Keys from universe U (think very large)
- ▶ Set $S \subseteq U$ of keys we actually care about (think relatively small). $|S| = N$.
- ▶ Hash table A (array) of size M .
- ▶ Hash function $h: U \rightarrow [M]$
 - ▶ $[M] = \{1, 2, \dots, M\}$
- ▶ Idea: store x in $A[h(x)]$

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One more component: *collision resolution*

- ▶ Today: *separate chaining*
- ▶ $A[i]$ is a linked list containing all x inserted where $h(x) = i$.



Dictionary Operations

Lookup(x): Walk down the list at $A[h(x)]$ until we find x (or walk to the end of the list)

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- ▶ h fast to compute.

Bad News

Theorem

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- ▶ Option 1: don't worry about it, hope world isn't adversarial.
- ▶ Option 2: Randomness! *Random function* $h: U \rightarrow [M]$
 - ▶ For each $x \in U$, choose $y \in [M]$ uniformly at random and set $h(x) = y$.
 - ▶ Hopefully good behavior in expectation.

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 - ▶ Hopefully good behavior in expectation.
 - ▶ Problem: How can we store/remember/create h ?

Universal Hashing

Definition

A probability distribution $\mathbf{H}$ over hash functions $\{\mathbf{h} : \mathbf{U} \rightarrow [\mathbf{M}]\}$ is *universal* if

$$\Pr_{h \sim H}[h(x) = h(y)] \leq 1/M$$

for all $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \in \mathbf{U}$ with $\mathbf{x} \neq \mathbf{y}$.

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If $\mathbf{H}$ is universal, then for every set $\mathbf{S} \subseteq \mathbf{U}$ with $|\mathbf{S}| = \mathbf{N}$ and for every $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbf{U}$, the expected number of collisions (when we draw h from $\mathbf{H}$) between $\mathbf{x}$ and elements of $\mathbf{S}$ is at most $\mathbf{N}/\mathbf{M}$.

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So Lookup($\mathbf{x}$) and Delete($\mathbf{x}$) have expected time $O(1 + \mathbf{N}/\mathbf{M})$.

$\implies$ If $\mathbf{M} = \Omega(\mathbf{N})$, operations in $O(1)$ time!

Linearity of Expectation

Amazing feature of expectations: linearity!

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For any two random variables $\mathbf{X}$ and $\mathbf{Y}$, and any constants α and β :

$$\mathbf{E}[\alpha\mathbf{X} + \beta\mathbf{Y}] = \alpha\mathbf{E}[\mathbf{X}] + \beta\mathbf{E}[\mathbf{Y}]$$

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$\implies \mathbf{E}[\mathbf{X}] = 3.5 + 3.5 = 7$

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Proof.

$$\text{Let } C_{xy} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } h(x) = h(y) \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\implies E[C_{xy}] = \Pr_{h \sim H}[h(x) = h(y)] \leq 1/M$$

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Number of collisions between x and $\mathbf{S}$ is exactly $\sum_{y \in \mathbf{S} \setminus \{x\}} C_{xy}$

$$\implies E\left[\sum_{y \in \mathbf{S} \setminus \{x\}} C_{xy}\right] = \sum_{y \in \mathbf{S} \setminus \{x\}} E[C_{xy}] \leq \sum_{y \in \mathbf{S} \setminus \{x\}} \frac{1}{M} = N/M$$



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If $\mathbf{H}$ is universal, then for any sequence of $\mathbf{L}$ insert, lookup, and delete operations in which there are at most $\mathbf{O(M)}$ elements in the system at any time, the expected total cost of the whole sequence is only $\mathbf{O(L)}$ (assuming $\mathbf{h}$ takes constant time to compute).

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So universal distributions are great. Can we construct them?

Universal Hash Families

Definition

If $\mathbf{H}$ is universal and is a uniform distribution over a set of functions $\{h_1, h_2, \dots\}$, then that set is called a *universal hash family*.

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Notation:

- ▶ $\mathbf{U} = \{0, 1\}^u$ (so $|\mathbf{U}| = 2^u$)
- ▶ $\mathbf{M} = 2^b$, so an index to $\mathbf{A}$ is an element of $\{0, 1\}^b$

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Construction: $\mathbf{H} = \{0, 1\}^{b \times u}$, i.e., $\mathbf{H}$ is all $b \times u$ binary matrices

- ▶ Each $h \in \mathbf{H}$ is a (linear) function from $\mathbf{U}$ to $[\mathbf{M}]$:
 $h(\mathbf{x}) = h\mathbf{x} \in \{0, 1\}^b$ (all operations mod 2)

$$\begin{array}{c} h \quad x \quad h(x) \\ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \end{array}$$

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Draw all entries of $\mathbf{h}$ except for $\mathbf{h}^i$. Let $\mathbf{h}' = \mathbf{h}$ with $\mathbf{h}^i$ all 0's

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- ▶ Happens with probability exactly $1/2^b = 1/M$



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Can we do better with hashing? Yes, through universal hashing!

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$$\begin{aligned}\Pr_{h \sim H}[\exists \text{ collision in } S] &\leq \sum_{\{x, y\} \in \binom{S}{2}} \Pr_{h \sim H}[h(x) = h(y)] \leq \sum_{\substack{x, y \in S \\ x \neq y}} \frac{1}{N^2} \\ &= \binom{N}{2} \frac{1}{N^2} = \frac{N(N-1)}{2} \frac{1}{N^2} \leq \frac{1}{2}\end{aligned}$$



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So keep sampling $h \sim H$ until get one with no collisions!

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- ▶ Use another hash table for S_i !
- ▶ Use Method 1: $O(n_i^2)$ -size perfect hashing of S_i .
 - ▶ Let $h_i : U \rightarrow [n_i^2]$ be hash function for S_i , and A_i be table (pointer from $A[i]$)

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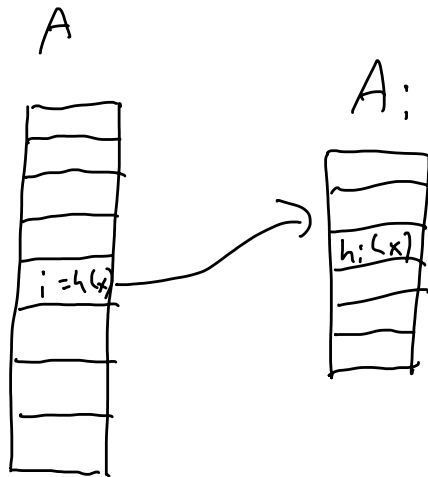
- ▶ Will have collisions. Need to do something other than chaining.

For each $i \in [M]$, let $S_i = \{x \in S : h(x) = i\}$ and let $n_i = |S_i|$

- ▶ Use another hash table for S_i !
- ▶ Use Method 1: $O(n_i^2)$ -size perfect hashing of S_i .
 - ▶ Let $h_i : U \rightarrow [n_i^2]$ be hash function for S_i , and A_i be table (pointer from $A[i]$)

Lookup(x): Look in $A_{h(x)}[h_{h(x)}(x)]$

Picture



Analysis

Lookup time: by analysis of Method 1, no collisions in second level.

⇒ Lookup time $O(1)$

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Theorem

Let H be universal onto a table of size N . Then

$$\Pr_{h \sim H} \left[\sum_{i=1}^N n_i^2 > 4N \right] < 1/2.$$

So like with method 1: keep drawing $h \sim H$ until $\sum_{i=1}^N n_i^2 \leq 4N$

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Prove that $E \left[\sum_{i=1}^N n_i^2 \right] \leq 2N$.

- ▶ Implies theorem by Markov's inequality
 - ▶ $\Pr[X > 2E[X]] \leq 1/2$ for nonnegative random variables X .

Proof

Observation: $\sum_{i=1}^N n_i^2$ is exactly number of *ordered* pairs that collide, including self-collisions

- ▶ Example: If $S_i = \{a, b, c\}$ then $n_i^2 = 9$. Ordered colliding pairs:
 $(a, a), (a, b), (a, c), (b, a), (b, b), (b, c), (c, a), (c, b), (c, c)$

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$$\text{Let } C_{xy} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } h(x) = h(y) \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

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$$\begin{aligned} E \left[\sum_{i=1}^N n_i^2 \right] &= E \left[\sum_{x \in S} \sum_{y \in S} C_{xy} \right] \\ &= N + \sum_{x \in S} \sum_{y \in S: y \neq x} E[C_{xy}] && \text{(linearity of expectations)} \\ &\leq N + \frac{N(N-1)}{M} && \text{(definition of universal)} \\ &< 2N && \text{(since } M = N) \end{aligned}$$